

Problem 2. Sakata Answers

2.1	13. <i>The dogs saw the bad goat.</i>
	14. <i>The children wanted to buy a big cow.</i>
	15. <i>The little man read the good books.</i>
	16. <i>Who killed the woman's snakes?</i>
2.2	17. Ngombe ijo mva inini. [3]
	18. Munde nejao ola mape. [3]
	19. Nə achunga kena kekikə ke bang? [4]
	20. Beto be kebil betang mekan menini. [4]

Q 2.1 Max 8. For each sentence, award 2 pts if correct; 1 pt with one mistake (e.g., wrong word, wrong singular/plural, missing question, ...)

Q 2.2 Max 14. In each sentence: 3 or 4 pts if correct (see above). Deduct 1 pt per mistake, to a minimum of 0.

Q 2.3 Max 33. 6 pts for describing the syntax; 14 pts for describing the agreement system; 11 pts for listing noun class prefixes; 2 pts for describing any irregularities.

Problem 2. Sakata Commentary

1. Syntax:

- Subject – Verb – [Infinitive] – Object
 - Verbs take **o-** in the infinitive, or an agreement prefix for their subject (see below).
- [**o** = *to*] – Noun – Adjective – [LNK – Possessor]
 - Adjectives take an agreement prefix.
 - In possessive constructions, LNK = agreement prefix for the possessed noun, as a free-standing linking word.

2. Noun class: all nouns begin with a noun class prefix.

	Singular		Plural	
	Noun prefix	Agreement prefix	Noun prefix	Agreement prefix
<i>woman, man, child, white man ...</i>	mu-	ne-	ba-	ba-
<i>book, ...</i>	mo-	mo-	me-	me-
<i>duck, wing, ...</i>	i-	le-	ma-	ma-
<i>field, thing, snake, ...</i>	ke-	ke-	be-	be-
<i>goat, dog, chicken, cow, ...</i>	n-	ne-	n-	i-
<i>peanut, ...</i>	le-	le-	n-	i-
nə = <i>who</i>		a-		

Note that here, all noun classes are either singular classes or plural classes. This is not true in general, although these represent the most common singular–plural pairs.

n-va > **mva** and **ba-nkar** > **banka**.

All data in this problem comes from the author's own fieldwork in Bosobe.